

1.1 Google Docs

Under the Google Documents umbrella of offerings comes three vital services—Documents, Spreadsheets and Presentations. Understandably, these are alternatives to MSWord, Excel and PowerPoint, respectively. So how do we go about using them?

1.1.1 Google Documents

As most of you probably know, one needs a universal Google account that can be used across all Google services. This means that in case you use Gmail then you already possess the prerequisites. To start off with the Google Docs suite, start off by visiting the URL <http://docs.google.com>, and enter your user ID and password.

To get a feel of how the online office suites function, start off with the word processor, also known as Documents. Just below the logo on the top left of the screen that says Google Docs Beta, you can see a drop down menu which says New. Once you click on New, you are given either of four options; namely, a new Document (Word), Spreadsheet (Excel), Presentation (PowerPoint) or Folder. We will first try out the Document Function—go to New > Document.

If you have ever used Microsoft Word, you would be able to sail through effortlessly. As you would have figured out by now, the blank page with the cursor is the beginning of your document.



A blank new document on Google Documents

You could continue typing in your leisure as much as you require. Similar to Gmail, Google Docs periodically saves the changes made, which comes in quite handy. In fact, keyboard shortcuts are similar to Microsoft Word, thereby giving you a feel of working on Word itself. You can adjust font sizes with the button marked “T”. Most of the functionalities here are similar to MS Word. Once your document is complete, the next step is saving.

Now consider this—you get a word processor, with password pro-